Two Scales, One State

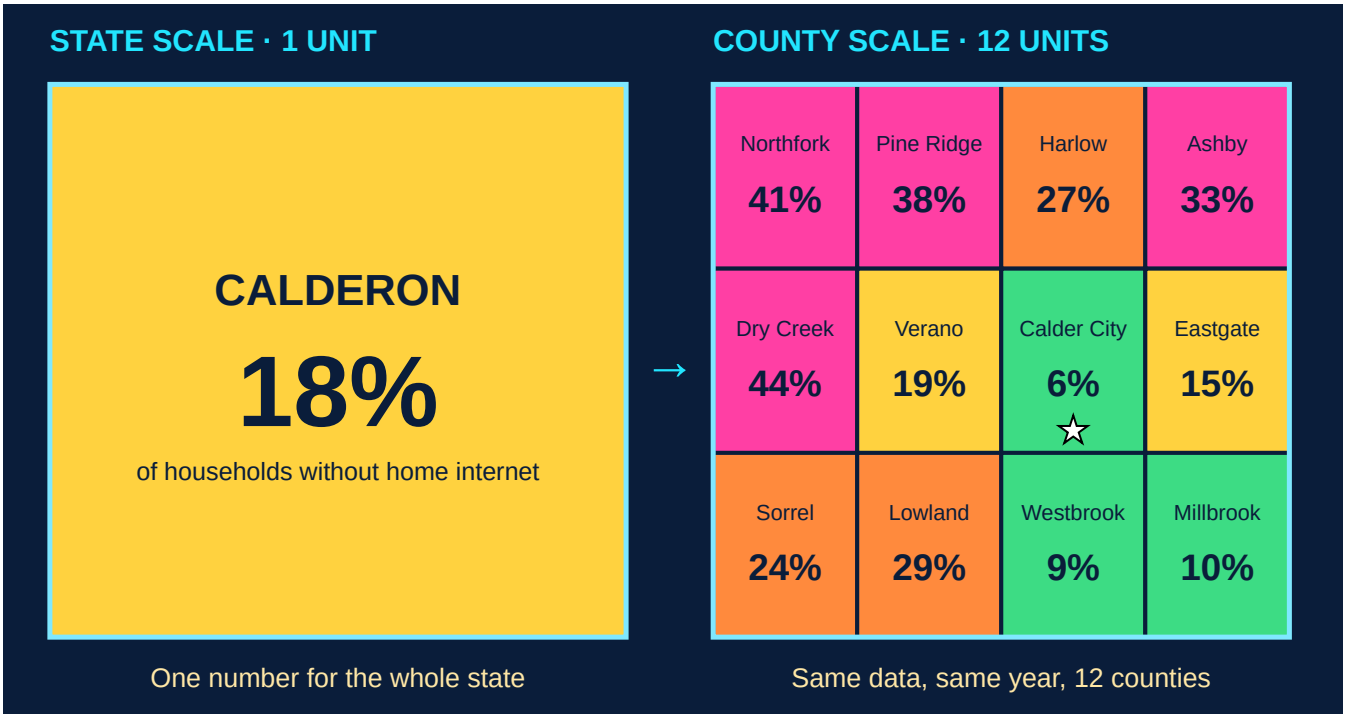
AP Human Geography · Unit 1 · One stimulus (like Question 2) · 7 points · Student handout · GeoArcade FRQ Tutor

Name _____ Date _____ Period _____

Directions: Answer all parts of the question. Respond in complete sentences; an outline or bulleted list is not acceptable. Label each part (A, B, C...). For Describe and Explain parts, write it out with **T1-** (your reason in general words), **E2-** (the specific proof), and **A3-** (why it matters).

Both maps show the same variable for the same fictional state in the same year. The left panel reports one value for the whole state. The right panel divides Calderon into its 12 counties. The capital, Calder City, is marked with a star.

Percent of Households Without Home Internet, State of Calderon (fictional), 2020: State Scale vs. County Scale



Data and places are invented for practice. The state figure is a population-weighted average: most of Calderon's people live in the metro counties around Calder City, so those low rates pull the state number down. Shapes simplified, not to scale.

A. Identify the type of thematic map used in the county-scale panel of the stimulus. IDENTIFY

_____

_____

B. Using the map, describe how the pattern of households without home internet changes between the state scale and the county scale. DESCRIBE

T1-

E2-

A3-

C. Explain ONE reason rural counties in Calderon have higher rates of households without home internet than the counties around the capital. EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

D. Using the map, explain ONE limitation of using only the state-level data to make decisions about improving internet access in Calderon. EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

E. Explain how a state government agency could use a geographic information system (GIS) to decide where to build new broadband internet infrastructure. EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-

F. Describe ONE way a dot density map or a graduated symbol map of the same data would show the pattern differently from the county choropleth. DESCRIBE

T1-

E2-

A3-

G. Explain how improved internet access in Calderon's rural counties is an example of time-space compression, and explain ONE effect it could have on a rural community. EXPLAIN

T1-

E2-

A3-